

AREA AND PERIMETER, (AREA OF RECTANGLES, TRIANGLES AND

Name: _____

Date: _____

LO: I can calculate the area of rectangles, triangles and parallelograms.

Area formulae

Area is the amount of space inside a 2D shape, measured in **square units** (cm², m²).

Formulae: Rectangle: $A = l \times w$. Triangle: $A = \frac{1}{2} \times b \times h$.
Parallelogram: $A = b \times h$ (perpendicular height).

Key facts

●	Rectangle: $A = \text{length} \times \text{width}$	$l \times w$
●	Triangle: $A = \frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height}$	half of rectangle
●	Parallelogram: $A = \text{base} \times \text{height}$	perpendicular h
●	Triangle: $A = \text{base} \times \text{height}$	forgot $\frac{1}{2}$
●	Parallelogram: use slant	must be

Key idea

Always use the PERPENDICULAR height (not the slant).
Triangle is half of the enclosing rectangle.

$$A = \left(\frac{1}{2}\right) \times b \times h$$

Triangle: half base times height

MODELLED EXAMPLES

Study each example carefully before attempting the practice questions.

Example 1 - rectangle

Find the area of a rectangle 8 cm by 5 cm.

$$A = l \times w$$

$$A = 8 \times 5$$

$$A = 40 \text{ cm}^2$$

$$= 40 \text{ cm}^2$$

Multiply length by width.

Example 2 - triangle

Find the area of a triangle with base 10 cm and height 6 cm.

$$A = \frac{1}{2} \times b \times h$$

$$A = \frac{1}{2} \times 10 \times 6$$

$$A = 30 \text{ cm}^2$$

$$= 30 \text{ cm}^2$$

Half of base times height.

Example 3 - parallelogram

A parallelogram has base 12 cm and perpendicular height 7 cm. Find its area.

$$A = b \times h$$

$$A = 12 \times 7$$

$$A = 84 \text{ cm}^2$$

$$= 84 \text{ cm}^2$$

Use the perpendicular height, not the slant side.

Example 4 - working backwards

A triangle has area 24 cm² and base 8 cm. Find the height.

$$A = \frac{1}{2} \times b \times h$$

$$24 = \frac{1}{2} \times 8 \times h \quad 24 = 4h$$

$$h = 6 \text{ cm}$$

$$h = 6 \text{ cm}$$

Rearrange the formula: $h = 2A \div b$.

YOUR TURN – PRACTICE (deliberate practice)

1. Area of rectangles

Find the area.

- a) $l = 7 \text{ cm}$, $w = 4 \text{ cm}$
- b) $l = 12 \text{ cm}$, $w = 5 \text{ cm}$
- c) $l = 9 \text{ cm}$, $w = 9 \text{ cm}$
- d) $l = 15 \text{ cm}$, $w = 3 \text{ cm}$

2. Area of triangles

Find the area. Use $A = \frac{1}{2} \times b \times h$.

- a) $b = 6 \text{ cm}$, $h = 4 \text{ cm}$
- b) $b = 10 \text{ cm}$, $h = 8 \text{ cm}$
- c) $b = 14 \text{ cm}$, $h = 5 \text{ cm}$
- d) $b = 9 \text{ cm}$, $h = 12 \text{ cm}$

3. Area of parallelograms

Find the area. Use perpendicular height.

- a) $b = 8 \text{ cm}$, $h = 6 \text{ cm}$
- b) $b = 11 \text{ cm}$, $h = 4 \text{ cm}$
- c) $b = 15 \text{ cm}$, $h = 9 \text{ cm}$
- d) $b = 7.5 \text{ cm}$, $h = 8 \text{ cm}$

4. Finding missing measurements

Find the missing length.

- a) Rectangle: $A = 36 \text{ cm}^2$, $l = 9 \text{ cm}$. Find w .
- b) Triangle: $A = 20 \text{ cm}^2$, $b = 8 \text{ cm}$. Find h .
- c) Parallelogram: $A = 72 \text{ cm}^2$, $h = 8 \text{ cm}$. Find b .
- d) Triangle: $A = 30 \text{ cm}^2$, $h = 10 \text{ cm}$. Find b .

5. Mixed area problems

Calculate each area.

- a) Rectangle: 6.5 cm by 4 cm
- b) Triangle: $b = 16 \text{ cm}$, $h = 7 \text{ cm}$
- c) Parallelogram: $b = 20 \text{ cm}$, $h = 3.5 \text{ cm}$
- d) Square: side 11 cm
- e) Triangle: $b = 5 \text{ cm}$, $h = 5 \text{ cm}$

COMMON MISCONCEPTIONS – SPOT THE MISTAKE

Each statement shows a student's answer. Tick () the ones that are correct. If it is wrong, write the correct answer.

a) Area of a triangle = $\frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height}$ ☐

Correct answer: _____
Reason: _____

b) Area of a triangle = $\text{base} \times \text{height}$ ☐

Correct answer: _____
Reason: _____

c) Parallelogram area uses perpendicular height ☐

Correct answer: _____
Reason: _____

d) Area is measured in cm ☐

Correct answer: _____
Reason: _____

e) A square is a special rectangle ☐

Correct answer: _____
Reason: _____

6. CHALLENGE – WORD PROBLEMS (apply your skills)

a) A rectangular garden is **12 m by 8 m**. A triangular flower bed has base **6 m** and height **4 m**. What fraction of the garden is the flower bed?

Expression: _____

Simplified: _____

b) A parallelogram and a triangle share the same **base of 10 cm** and the same **height of 6 cm**. What is the relationship between their areas? Will this always be true?

Expression: _____

Simplified: _____

TOP TIPS

Read the question carefully. Show all your working step by step.
Check your answer makes sense.

CHECK YOUR WORK

- Have I shown all my working clearly?
- Did I check my answer using a different method?
- Does my answer look reasonable?

